PhD/Master Applicant

Cheng Chen

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GPA 4.66/5.00, rank 3/87
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Application Strengths

- Tongji University undergraduate in Communication Engineering, GPA **4.66/5.00**, major rank **3/87**, with a consistent research line in multimodal intelligence, trustworthy reasoning, deployable AI, and wireless intelligence.
- Research record follows a clear top-venue pipeline: **IJCAI 2026** accepted co-first work; two double-blind **ACM MM 2026** submissions with initial scores **4/4/4/4/3** and **4/4/3/2**; accepted corresponding-author papers at **IJCNN 2026** and **ICANN 2026**; first-author **NeurIPS 2026** and **IEEE WCL** submissions under review.
- Prepared for PhD/Master research in audio-visual multimodal understanding, open-vocabulary perception, reliable reasoning, risk-aware deployment, and learning-assisted wireless systems.

Education

B.Eng. in Communication Engineering, Tongji University, Shanghai, China — 2023.09 – Present
GPA: **4.66/5.00**; major rank: **3/87**; CET-6: **519**.
Selected coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Digital Signal Processing, Probability and Statistics, Signals and Systems, Digital Electronics, Information Theory, Computer Networks, Embedded Systems.

Research Outputs

OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment — IJCAI 2026
C. Chen*, Y. Xu*, and M. Cao. **Accepted; co-first author.**
Proposed orthogonal knowledge distillation for heterogeneous clinical teachers and lightweight deployment.

Anonymous ACM MM 2026 Submissions A / B (double-blind review) — ACM MM 2026
Co-first author / first author; initial scores: 4/4/4/4/3 (approx. top 5%) and 4/4/3/2 (approx. top 20–30%).
Topics cover open-vocabulary audio-visual event localization and transferable deformation attacks for visual security.

Enabling Visual Reasoning in Text-Only LLMs via Symbolic Scene Descriptions — IJCNN 2026
W. Lei, M. Cao, C. Ye, Y. Xu, and **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Encoded visual scenes as structured symbolic descriptions to support visual reasoning by text-only LLMs.

Beyond Relevance: Counter-Evidence Planning in a Controlled Budgeted RAG Testbed — ICANN 2026
Y. Cai, Y. Xu, and **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Studied counter-evidence planning for fixed-budget RAG and reliability-oriented retrieval decisions.

Anonymous neural-operator risk assessment project — NeurIPS 2026
Under review; first author.
Researches single-pass risk triage and deployable risk assessment for neural operators.

Learning-Aided Privacy Beamforming for ISAC — IEEE WCL 2026
IEEE Wireless Communications Letters under review; first author.
Studies privacy-aware beamforming under eavesdropper location uncertainty.

Competitions & Awards

National Second Prize, Global Campus Artificial Intelligence Algorithm Elite Competition — 2025
National Third Prize, National College Students' Embedded Systems Competition — 2025

Research Skills

- **Method design:** knowledge distillation, multimodal learning, symbolic visual reasoning, RAG planning, risk triage, robustness evaluation, and privacy-aware ISAC.
- **Research execution:** PyTorch-based modeling, ablation and benchmark design, error analysis, reproducible experiments, technical writing, and LaTeX manuscript preparation.